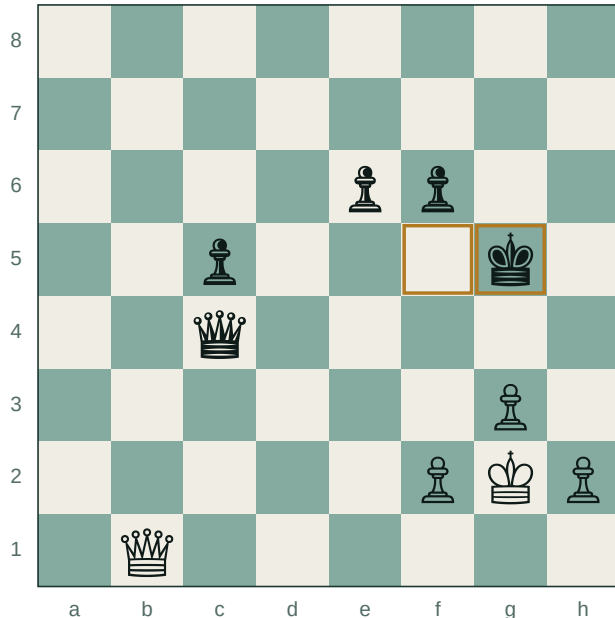


Queen-ending tactics: White, move 35

Queen-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 34...Kg5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35. Qh7 Qd5+ 36. f3 Qd2+ 37. Kh3 Qe3 38. f4+

35.Qh7 The queen moves from b1 to h7. Recorded reply: **35...Qd5+**.

36.f3 The pawn moves from f2 to f3. Recorded reply: **36...Qd2+**.

37.Kh3 The king moves from g2 to h3. Recorded reply: **37...Qe3**.

38.f4+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on g5. Geometrically undefended: queen on c4. Check for tactical protection.